



Figure 2: GNOME Sushi preview



Figure 3: Gloobus Preview

Gloobus Preview

As per the Gloobus site, “Gloobus Preview is a GNOME application based on Apple’s ‘Quicklook’, designed to enable a full screen preview of any kind of file.”

Note: 1. At the time of writing this article, the Gloobus Preview site was not accessible, so if you too try to go to the site <http://gloobus.net/gloobus-preview/> and find it inaccessible, use the Google Cache service to access a snapshot of the site. All instructions about Gloobus Preview are as defined on the snapshot of the site.

2. As per the Gloobus page, the following file types are supported:

Images: Jpeg / Png / Icn5 / Bmp / Svg / Gif / PSD / xcf
Documents: PDF / cbz / cbz / doc / xls / odf / ods / odp / PPT
Source code: C++ / C# / Java / Javascript / PHP / Xml / log / sh / Python
Audio: Mp3 / Ogg / midi / 3gp / wav
Video: Mpg / avi / ogg / 3gp / mkv / flv
Other: folders / ttf / srt / plain text

As the Ubuntu handbook points out, “Gloobus Preview

is available for Ubuntu 13.04, Ubuntu 12.04, Ubuntu 12.10 and Ubuntu 11.10 from the PPA repository.” Sadly, the PPA is not ready for Ubuntu 13.10 yet.

Now, let’s install it by issuing the following commands:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:gloobus-dev/gloobus-
preview
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install gloobus-preview gloobus-sushi
```

The PPA also has packages for older Ubuntu versions, but you’ll need to use Nautilus Elementary so that the keyboard shortcut works. For versions of Ubuntu older than 11.10, don’t install ‘gloobus-sushi’. If you do, it will replace GNOME Sushi (if installed).

Note: Again, to preview open format documents (like .odt and ODF), you also need to install another package named *unocom* with the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install unocom
```

If you want to install Gloobus Preview for other distributions, it can always be downloaded via its Launchpad (<https://launchpad.net/gloobus-preview/>). Figure 3 gives a screenshot of Gloobus Preview.

So who’s the winner?

It’s difficult to comment on who the winner is as both tools are excellent. But for me, Gloobus Preview is the winner, because it loads files faster than Sushi and has a sleek interface so that the user can focus on the content. Plus, it has a low memory footprint. **END**

References

- [1] <http://gloobus.net/gloobus-preview/>
- [2] <https://launchpad.net/gloobus-preview>
- [3] <http://www.webupd8.org/2012/04/gloobus-preview-update-brings-gtk3-and.html>
- [4] <http://ubuntuhandbook.org/index.php/2013/08/install-gloobus-preview-in-ubuntu-13-04/>
- [5] <https://launchpad.net/gnome-sushi>

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